

University Disciplinary Committee Hearing Records & Formal Findings AY 2025-2026

Office of Student Conduct & Dean of Students | CONFIDENTIAL Case Dossiers & Sanctions

STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL — DISCIPLINARY COMMITTEE HEARING ARCHIVES. This document contains formal findings, forensic evidence summaries, legal deliberations, and sanctions issued by the University Disciplinary Committee and Academic Integrity Board. Distribution to unauthorized personnel constitutes a direct violation of institutional confidentiality regulations and applicable privacy statutes. Access: Dean of Students Affairs, Registrar, Dean of Academic Affairs, University Legal Counsel, and Provost only.

1. Disciplinary Committee Structure, Quorum & Procedural Standards

The University Disciplinary Committee (UDC) is constituted under University Statute Chapter 12 and the UGC (Prevention, Prohibition and Punishment of Ragging in HEIs) Regulations 2009. The UDC comprises: the Dean of Student Affairs (Chair), the Registrar, two senior professors nominated by the Academic Senate (one of whom must be a woman), one legal adviser (qualified advocate), and one student ombudsperson representative. Quorum requires 4 members including the Chair. All hearings are conducted in accordance with principles of natural justice: respondents are guaranteed: (a) written notice of charges at least 5 working days before hearing; (b) right to review all evidence; (c) right to present a defense and submit written response; (d) right to be accompanied by a faculty representative; (e) right to appeal the UDC decision to the Dean within 10 working days.

2. Hearing DH-2025-014: Academic Dishonesty — Devon K. Ramirez

Respondent: Devon K. Ramirez (Roll No: 2024BDSE009, Sem II, Data Science) **Complainant:** Dr. Elena Marsh, CS301 Course Instructor **Hearing Date:** November 3, 2025 | **Panel Chair:** Prof. Marcus Vance, Chair of Academic Integrity Board

Charges: Level 2 Academic Dishonesty — submission of CS301 Laboratory Assignment 3 (SQL Query Design for E-Commerce Schema) containing 92% syntactic similarity to a solution posted on a public repository (GitHub gist: [redacted]) and distributing solution files to 3 peer students via WhatsApp group chat.

Forensic Evidence: (a) MOSS code similarity analysis (Stanford MOSS, run November 1, 2025) reported 92% non-trivial structural similarity between the respondent's submission and the external repository. (b) WhatsApp message export (voluntarily produced by complainant student) showed respondent sharing the file 'assignment3_solution_final.sql' at 11:42 PM on October 29, 2025, 18 hours before the submission deadline. (c) Examination of submission metadata confirmed identical SQL comments, identical column aliases, and a unique typographic error ('INNERJOIN' without space) replicated verbatim from the source repository.

Respondent Defense: Student submitted a written defense acknowledging use of an 'online reference' but denied intentional plagiarism, claiming lack of clarity about what constituted academic misconduct in SQL lab assignments. The Panel noted that the course syllabus explicitly prohibits external solution references and that the student had signed the Honor Pledge at semester commencement.

Findings & Sanctions (Panel Vote: 4–1 Uphold): (1) Zero credit (0/50) on Laboratory Assignment 3. (2) Final course grade reduced by one full letter grade (the student's earned B+ becomes B). (3) Mandatory 4-week Academic Ethics and Integrity Workshop (AEIWRM program, next cohort starts January 12, 2026). (4) Formal Conduct Warning entered into the student's confidential institutional dossier (retained for 5 years or until graduation, whichever is later). (5) The 3 students who received the shared file receive formal written cautions; their submissions will be assigned reduced credit (20% penalty) pending individual intent assessment.

3. Hearing DH-2025-021: Hostel Regulations Violation — Naomi L. Chen

Respondent: Naomi L. Chen (Roll No: 2022BSWE012) **Incident Date:** October 28, 2025, 12:45 AM | **Location:** Sarojini Hostel Block B, Room B-214 **Charge:** Violation of Hostel Regulations Section 4.2 (noise breach during mandatory quiet hours 11 PM–6 AM) and Section 4.6 (unauthorized guests — 2 non-resident students present after 10:30 PM gate closure). **Evidence:** CCTV footage from Block B corridor at 12:45 AM showing 2 additional persons entering Room B-214; warden's inspection log documenting noise complaint from neighboring Room B-216. **Sanctions Imposed:** Written Reprimand (Level 1); administrative hostel fine of Rs. 2,500 (processed to student's campus account); 15 hours of campus library community service (shelving and cataloging) to be completed before November 30.

4. Hearing DH-2025-035: Cybersecurity Violation — Liam P. O'Connor

Respondent: Liam P. O'Connor (Roll No: 2023BCSE031, Year 3 CSE) **Hearing Date:** November 24, 2025 | **Panel Chair:** Dean Arthur Pendelton

Charges (Level 3 — Major Violation): Unauthorized access attempt against the University Faculty Grading Server (secure.grades.northgate.edu) on November 12, 2025 from 02:14 AM to 02:47 AM via: (a) automated port scan of 4,096 ports (Nmap scan detected by the SOC SIEM at 02:16 AM); (b) attempted SQL injection against the faculty login form (8 distinct injection payloads detected by WAF, logged at 02:23 AM); (c) directory traversal attempt targeting '/admin/grade_upload' endpoint (blocked by Apache ModSecurity, logged at 02:41 AM).

Forensic Evidence: (a) SOC incident log INC-2025-1112-0047 confirming all attack traffic originated from IP address 10.42.87.211 (assigned to respondent's registered laptop via university RADIUS server at 02:13 AM); (b) respondent's device found to contain Nmap, SQLmap, and Burp Suite Community Edition installed (surrendered to IT Security during device forensic examination); (c) respondent's LDAP authentication log shows a failed 'grade_admin' login attempt at 02:38 AM. Respondent produced no credible defense — claimed 'testing cybersecurity knowledge for academic purposes' without any instructor authorization or lab clearance.

Sanctions (Panel Vote: 5-0 Uphold — Unanimous): (1) One-semester mandatory academic suspension for Spring 2026 (all academic activities suspended). (2) Permanent revocation of all campus computing laboratory, Wi-Fi, and server access — no reinstatement permissible under any circumstances. (3) Mandatory parent and legal guardian counseling session with the Dean of Student Affairs before any readmission petition is considered. (4) Referral to University Legal Counsel for assessment of criminal cybersecurity charges under IT Act 2000 Sections 43 and 66 — report filed with local Cyber Crime Cell. (5) Conduct notation on academic transcript: 'Academic Suspension — IT Act Cybersecurity Violation Nov 2025.'

5. Hearing DH-2025-042: Unauthorized Examination Material Procurement — Tyler R. Scott

Respondent: Tyler R. Scott (Roll No: 2023BCE019) **Hearing Date:** December 2, 2025 **Charge:** Level 3 — Unauthorized procurement of draft CAT-2 examination question papers for 3 courses prior to the examination date. **Evidence:** Laboratory printer audit log (Print Server Log: PSL-2025-1022-003) showing respondent's LDAP credential authenticated a print job titled 'CAT2_Draft_CS301_CS340_CS355.pdf' from a research lab workstation at 4:47 PM on October 22, 2025 (draft papers stored on shared faculty network drive, accessible due to misconfigured permissions — remediated November 1). Physical copies of the papers recovered from respondent's hostel room during authorized search. **Sanctions:** (1) 'F' grade assigned to all 3 registered courses for Fall 2025 semester. (2) One-year academic suspension effective January 2026. (3) University Information Security team implemented mandatory role-based access control (RBAC) audit of all faculty network shares as a remedial system action.

6. Hearing DH-2025-055: Disruptive Conduct — Marcus D. Whitfield

Respondent: Marcus D. Whitfield (Roll No: 2023BCSE042) **Hearing Date:** October 14, 2025 **Charge:** Level 1 — Disruptive conduct in the Central Computing Center during the Semester V Practical Examination Session 2B (October 13, 2025). Specifically: refusal to vacate allocated computing terminal 45 minutes after the 3-hour session concluded, preventing the next batch from beginning their allotted examination time; and verbal confrontation with the laboratory invigilator involving raised voice and use of inappropriate language. **Respondent Statement:** Student acknowledges the confrontation and attributes it to severe examination stress. Student expressed sincere remorse in writing. **Sanctions:** (1) Formal Written Reprimand. (2) 10 hours of supervised community service in the Central Computing Center (equipment cleaning and maintenance, weekends). (3) Mandatory 2-session anger management and stress resilience workshop through the Student Wellness Center. (4) This incident factored into the advisor's comprehensive assessment in the student's Academic Probation case file.

7. Hearing DH-2025-062: Unauthorized Drone Operation — Hannah M. Zhao

Respondent: Hannah M. Zhao (Roll No: 2023BEE011) **Hearing Date:** November 18, 2025 **Charge:** Level 1 — Operating an unregistered commercial quadcopter drone (DJI Mini 4 Pro) over Sarojini Hostel residential zone and the Women's Sports Ground on October 30, 2025 without prior security clearance, drone registration (DGCA UAS portal), and written authorization from Campus Security. The drone was operated for 22 minutes between 6:18 PM and 6:40 PM, recording video footage. **Evidence:** Real-time drone detection alert from campus RF monitoring system (DroneShield installed Aug 2025); CCTV footage of respondent operating controller; drone registration check confirmed no DGCA UAS ID assigned. **Sanctions:** (1) Drone apparatus and controller confiscated and held by Campus Security until June 2026 or degree completion, whichever is later. (2) Written Reprimand. (3) Mandatory DGCA UAS Rules 2021 compliance training (online, 4 hours). (4) Written undertaking from respondent not to operate UAVs on campus without prior clearance through the new Campus UAS Authorization Protocol (CUAP) effective January 2026.

8. University Statutory Disciplinary Sanctions Matrix

Misconduct is classified into three severity tiers with prescribed sanction ranges: **Level 1 (Minor)**: Unintentional citation omission, hostel quiet-hour breach, first-time unauthorized software installation, minor noise violation. Sanctions: Written Reprimand; assignment resubmission with 20% grade penalty; community service 10–20 hours. **Level 2 (Moderate)**: Plagiarism on course assignment, unauthorized collaboration in programming lab, sharing solution files. Sanctions: Zero grade on component; course grade reduction by one letter; mandatory Academic Ethics Workshop; formal conduct warning on record. **Level 3 (Major/Severe)**: Examination paper procurement/distribution, server hacking, impersonation, physical assault. Sanctions: 'F' grade in all courses for the term; one-year academic suspension to permanent expulsion; transcript conduct notation; criminal referral when warranted.

9. Disciplinary Records Retention, Expungement & Privacy Protocols

Disciplinary case dossiers are maintained under sealed custody in the Office of Student Conduct (physical: fireproof vault, Room 004B, Admin Block; digital: encrypted DCMP Disciplinary Module with role-gated access). Retention schedules: Level 1 records are expunged from the active dossier 3 years after graduation, provided no further infractions; Level 2 records retained for 7 years; Level 3 records retained permanently. External disclosure of disciplinary records is permissible only upon: (a) written consent of the affected student; (b) valid court subpoena or law enforcement order; (c) request from a professional licensing board or security clearance authority citing a legal basis. Internal sharing follows a strict need-to-know principle: only the Dean, Registrar, and the student's assigned Faculty Advisor have read access to the full dossier.